

Where NCI Cancer Research *Money* Goes

NCI OFFICIAL DATA

cancer.gov/about-nci/budget

JUNE 07, 2026 · STOREHOUSE DB — NCI_LOADER.PY — LAST LOADED: 2026-06-07 10:06

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The National Cancer Institute reports how appropriated funds are spent across different cancer research areas.

Important for patients and caregivers: These research areas overlap. A project studying breast cancer in a clinical trial is counted in both “Breast Cancer” and “Clinical Trials.” The individual cancer totals do not add up to the NCI total budget — this is by design, not an error.

Why does this report only go to 2023? NCI publishes cancer-type spending data after a reconciliation process that takes 1–2 years to complete. Each research project must be manually coded to one or more cancer types before the figures are finalized. As of June 07, 2026, the most recent cancer-type breakdown available from NCI covers fiscal year 2023. FY2024 and FY2025 cancer-by-cancer breakdowns have not yet been published by NCI. The overall NCI budget for FY2024 (\$7.2 billion) is known, but how that money was distributed across cancer types has not yet been reported. This report will automatically include newer data as soon as NCI publishes it.

Can these numbers be used to estimate current spending? No — not with precision. The 2023 figures are the last known cancer-type breakdown. Budget priorities shift with each administration, annual appropriations, and advocacy efforts. The percentages and dollar amounts in this report reflect 2023 only. They should be used as a baseline and a trend indicator — not as a statement of what NCI is spending today. The correct way to cite this data is: *“In FY2023, the most recent year for which NCI has published a cancer-type breakdown, [cancer type] received [amount] — [percent] of the NCI budget.”*

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

- **Dollar amounts** — NCI investment in millions (M) or billions (B) USD, including direct and indirect costs
- **% of NCI (2023)** — that cancer’s share of the total NCI budget in 2023
- **YoY (2017→2023)** — change over the full period shown. ▲ Green = more funding. ▼ Red = less funding.
- Years marked Actual are final figures; Estimated years may be revised by NCI

CANCER RESEARCH FUNDING BY TYPE — USD MILLIONS

How much NCI invested in research for each specific cancer type

FUNDING CHANGES 2017→2023

▲ Largest increases			▼ Largest decreases		
Liver Cancer	\$73M → \$114M	▲ 57.0%	Multiple Myeloma	\$61M → \$55M	▼ 9.5%
Pancreatic Cancer	\$178M → \$246M	▲ 37.9%	Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma	\$120M → \$117M	▼ 2.1%
Lung Cancer	\$321M → \$435M	▲ 35.7%	Breast Cancer	\$545M → \$542M	▼ 0.6%
Ovarian Cancer	\$110M → \$132M	▲ 20.2%			
Colorectal Cancer	\$208M → \$239M	▲ 14.5%			
Cancers with statistical anomalies (marked * in table below) are excluded from this summary. Anomalies reflect NCI coding classification changes, not actual budget shifts.					

Cancer Type	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	Rank (2023)	% of NCI (2023)	YOY 2017→2023
Total NCI Budget	\$5.64B	\$5.93B	\$5.99B	\$6.38B	\$6.47B	\$6.83B	\$7.22B	—	100%	▲ 28.1%
Breast Cancer	\$545M	\$575M	\$545M	\$515M	\$558M	\$581M	\$542M	#1 /17	7.5%	▼ 0.6%
Lung Cancer	\$321M	\$350M	\$418M	\$403M	\$459M	\$477M	\$435M	#2 /17	6.0%	▲ 35.7%
Leukemia	\$251M	\$258M	\$257M	\$244M	\$276M	\$287M	\$271M	#3 /17	3.7%	▲ 8.0%
Prostate Cancer	\$233M	\$239M	\$245M	\$209M	\$270M	\$280M	\$259M	#4 /17	3.6%	▲ 11.0%
Colorectal Cancer	\$208M	\$256M	\$239M	\$212M	\$248M	\$258M	\$239M	#6 /17	3.3%	▲ 14.5%
Pancreatic Cancer	\$178M	\$182M	\$187M	\$178M	\$218M	\$227M	\$246M	#5 /17	3.4%	▲ 37.9%
Brain & CNS	\$220M	\$221M	\$232M	\$595M*	\$251M	\$261M	\$236M	#7 /17	3.3%	▲ 7.4%
Melanoma	\$153M	\$158M	\$192M	\$156M	\$179M	\$186M	\$157M	#8 /17	2.2%	▲ 2.8%
Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma	\$120M	\$121M	\$120M	\$120M	\$138M	\$143M	\$117M	#10 /17	1.6%	▼ 2.1%
Ovarian Cancer	\$110M	\$121M	\$122M	\$116M	\$135M	\$140M	\$132M	#9 /17	1.8%	▲ 20.2%
Liver Cancer	\$73M	\$95M	\$108M	\$96M	\$112M	\$116M	\$114M	#11 /17	1.6%	▲ 57.0%

CANCER TYPE	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	RANK (2023)	% OF NCI (2023)	YOY 2017→2023
Cervical Cancer	\$68M	\$71M	\$86M	\$69M	\$74M	\$77M	\$21M	#15 /17	0.3%	▼ 69.6%
Multiple Myeloma	\$61M	\$61M	\$58M	\$43M	\$51M	\$53M	\$55M	#13 /17	0.8%	▼ 9.5%
Hodgkin Disease	\$13M	\$13M	\$12M	\$14M	\$16M	\$17M	\$7M	#17 /17	0.1%	▼ 43.9%
Stomach Cancer	\$13M	\$14M	\$15M	\$11M	\$15M	\$16M	\$33M *	#14 /17	0.5%	▲ 146.8%
Uterine Cancer	\$18M	\$17M	\$18M	\$14M	\$14M	\$15M	\$20M	#16 /17	0.3%	▲ 14.2%
Head and Neck Cancers	\$64M	\$62M	\$72M	\$50M	\$69M	\$55M	\$70M	#12 /17	1.0%	▲ 9.9%

Rank by 2023 funding among 17 cancer-specific research areas in this table · % of NCI calculated from 2023 figures in this report · Not a separately sourced figure · Percentages do not sum to 100% — research areas overlap and this table does not represent the entire NCI portfolio

* Marked values are statistical anomalies — the figure is more than twice the surrounding years, indicating a likely NCI coding classification change rather than an actual budget shift. These figures are reported exactly as published in the NCI Fact Book.

HOW TO CITE THIS DATA

“In FY2023, the most recent year for which NCI has published a cancer-type spending breakdown, [cancer type] received \$X million — representing Y% of the NCI budget.”

Source: NCI Budget Fact Book, Funding for Research Areas, cancer.gov/about-nci/budget/fact-book/data/research-funding

CROSS-CUTTING RESEARCH CATEGORIES — USD MILLIONS

These span multiple cancer types. A breast cancer clinical trial counts here AND in Breast Cancer above. Do not add these to the cancer totals.

RESEARCH CATEGORY	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	% OF NCI (2023)	YOY 2017→2023
AIDS	\$249M	\$241M	\$242M	\$242M	\$249M	\$259M	\$270M	—	3.7% ▲ 8.2%
Clinical Trials	\$807M	\$890M	\$794M	\$843M	\$825M	\$858M	\$852M	—	11.8% ▲ 5.7%

Overlaps with cancer-specific totals above — do not add together

Methodology: NCI uses its own internal coding system to categorize research spending — the same methodology used in NCI’s official congressional budget reporting. Because research projects often address multiple cancer types, individual totals do not sum to the NCI total.

Data currency: Data is loaded monthly into storehouse.db by nci_loader.py, which downloads the NCI Budget Fact Book Excel and upserts observations. The report reads from the database — no internet connection required at report generation time.

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